

Word family: **good / better / best / well / bettered / bettering**

Target word: better

Part of speech: mainly **adjective** and **adverb**, also **noun** and **verb**

Important irregular relationship:

* **good → better → best**

* **well → better → best**

So **better** can be the comparative form of either:

* **good** → better = 更好的

* **well** → better = 更好地；身體更好

Related forms / useful extensions:

* **better than**

* **much/far/a lot better**

* **slightly better**

* **get better**

* **feel better**

* **look better**

* **better at**

* **better for**

* **better off**

* **had better**

* **the better of the two**

* **for the better**

* **know better**

* **better yourself**

* **better someone's record**

* **better late than never**

Meaning in this passage

> “That's okay, we can build a **better** one.”

Here, **better** means:

of higher quality or more successful than the previous one — 更好的；品質更高的

Leo means that although the first cardboard bridge was broken, they can make another bridge that is **better than the original one**.

****中文翻譯：****

「沒關係，我們可以再造一座****更好的****。」

So here:

****better** = 比之前那個更好、品質或效果更佳的******

The comparison is understood even though ****than the old one**** is not stated explicitly.

1. ****better** (比較級：更好的) — 更好的；較佳的******

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> We can build a ****better**** one.

我們可以再造一座****更好的****。

Practice 2

> This design is ****better**** than the previous one.

這個設計比之前那個****更好****。

Practice 3

> We need a ****better solution**** to the problem.

我們需要一個****更好的解決方法****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****better** = 品質、效果、表現或適合程度比另一個更高的******

2. ****better than** — 比.....更好******

Practice 1

> This restaurant is ****better than**** the one we tried last week.

這間餐廳比我們上星期去的那間**更好**。

Practice 2

> The second version is much **better than** the first.

第二個版本比第一個**好得多**。

MCQ-ready definition:

better than X = 與 X 比較時，品質、效果或表現較佳

3. **much / far / a lot better — 好得多**

Practice 1

> This explanation is **much better**.

這個解釋**好得多**。

Practice 2

> She feels **far better** today.

她今天感覺**好多了**。

MCQ-ready definition:

much/far/a lot better = 比較之下明顯好很多

4. **slightly / a little better — 好一點**

Practice 1

> This version is **slightly better**.

這個版本**稍微好一點**。

Practice 2

> I'm feeling **a little better** now.

我現在感覺**好一點了**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****slightly/a little better = 只比原來好少許****

5. ****get better (情況改善) — 變好 ; 改善****

Practice 1

> The weather should ****get better**** tomorrow.

明天天氣應該會****轉好****。

Practice 2

> Things gradually ****got better**** after the first few weeks.

最初幾星期過後，情況逐漸****好轉****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****get better = 情況、狀態或品質逐漸改善****

6. ****get better (身體康復) — 好起來 ; 康復****

Practice 1

> I hope you ****get better**** soon.

希望你早日****康復****。

Practice 2

> She is slowly ****getting better**** after the illness.

病後她正在慢慢****好起來****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****get better = 身體狀況改善，逐漸從疾病或受傷中康復****

7. ****feel better — 感覺好一點 ; 身體 / 心情改善****

Practice 1

> I feel much **better** after resting.

休息後我感覺**好多了**。

Practice 2

> Talking to a friend made her feel **better**.

跟朋友談過後，她感覺**好一點了**。

MCQ-ready definition:

feel better = 身體或情緒比之前舒服、健康或穩定

8. **look better** — 看起來更好 / 氣色更佳

Practice 1

> You look much **better** today.

你今天看起來**好多了**。

Practice 2

> The room looks **better** with more natural light.

房間有更多自然光後看起來**更好看了**。

MCQ-ready definition:

look better = 外觀、狀態或氣色比以前更佳

9. **work better** — 運作得更好

Here **better** functions adverbially.

Practice 1

> The machine works **better** after the repair.

維修後，機器**運作得更好了**。

Practice 2

> I work **better** in a quiet environment.

我在安靜的環境下**工作得更好**。

MCQ-ready definition:

better = 以較佳、更有效或更成功的方式

10. **do better — 做得更好；表現更佳**

Practice 1

> You can **do better** next time.

你下次可以**做得更好**。

Practice 2

> The team did **better** in the second half.

球隊下半場**表現得更好**。

MCQ-ready definition:

do better = 在工作、比賽、學習等方面取得較佳表現

11. **better at something — 更擅長某事**

Practice 1

> She is **better at maths** than I am.

她比我**更擅長數學**。

Practice 2

> I'm getting **better at speaking English**.

我的英語口語正在**進步 / 變得更熟練**。

MCQ-ready definition:

better at something = 在某項技能或活動方面能力較高

12. ****better for someone/something — 對.....更好；更有利****

Practice 1

> Walking is ****better for your health**** than sitting all day.

步行比整天坐着****更有利健康****。

Practice 2

> This arrangement may be ****better for everyone****.

這個安排可能****對大家更好****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****better for someone/something = 對某人或某事更有益、更合適或更有利****

13. ****better suited to/for — 更適合****

Practice 1

> This job is ****better suited to**** someone with experience.

這份工作****更適合****有經驗的人。

Practice 2

> The smaller room is ****better suited for**** private meetings.

較小的房間****更適合****私人會議。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****better suited to/for = 與某個用途、人物或情況更匹配****

14. ****better option / choice — 更好的選擇****

Practice 1

> Taking the train may be the ****better option****.

乘火車可能是**較好的選擇**。

Practice 2

> Of the two designs, this is the **better choice**.

兩個設計之中，這個是**較佳的選擇**。

MCQ-ready definition:

better option/choice = 在幾個選擇中較合適、較有利或品質較高的一個

15. **the better of two — 兩者中較好的那個**

Practice 1

> This is the **better of the two**.

這是兩者中**較好的一個**。

Practice 2

> Neither plan is perfect, but the second is the **better of the two**.

兩個計劃都不完美，但第二個是兩者中**較好的**。

MCQ-ready definition:

the better of two = 兩個人或事物當中較佳的一個

16. **for the better — 朝好的方向；有所改善**

Practice 1

> The change was definitely **for the better**.

這個改變確實是**朝好的方向發展**。

Practice 2

> His life changed **for the better** after he moved.

搬家後，他的生活**變得更好了**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****for the better = 令情況比以前改善、向較好的方向發展****

17. ****better off — 處境更好；更有利****

A very important fixed expression.

Practice 1

> We'd be ****better off**** taking the train.

我們乘火車可能會****更好 / 更有利****。

Practice 2

> She is financially ****better off**** than she was five years ago.

她現在的經濟狀況比五年前****更好****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****better off = 處於較有利、較舒服或較富裕的狀況****

18. ****better off doing something — 做某事會比較好****

Practice 1

> You're ****better off waiting**** until tomorrow.

你****最好等到明天****。

Practice 2

> We may be ****better off leaving early****.

我們****早點離開可能比較好****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****be better off doing something = 做某件事對某人而言會帶來較好的結果****

19. ****had better do something — 最好做某事****

This is a major grammar structure.

Practice 1

> You **had better leave** now.

你**最好現在離開**。

Practice 2

> We'd **better hurry**, or we'll miss the bus.

我們**最好快點**，否則會錯過巴士。

MCQ-ready definition:

had better do something = 強烈建議某人做某事，通常暗示不做可能有不好的後果

20. **had better not do something** — 最好不要做某事

Practice 1

> You'd **better not touch** that.

你**最好不要碰**那個。

Practice 2

> We'd **better not be late**.

我們**最好不要遲到**。

MCQ-ready definition:

had better not do something = 強烈建議不要做某事，因為可能帶來負面後果

21. **know better** — 應該懂得不要那樣做；明知不該

Practice 1

> You should **know better** than to lie about something so serious.

你應該**懂得不應該**在這麼嚴重的事情上說謊。

Practice 2

> He's old enough to **know better**.

他已經夠大，**應該懂事了**。

MCQ-ready definition:

know better = 因經驗、年齡或常識而應該知道甚麼做法是不對或不明智的

22. **know better than to do something** — 知道不應該做某事

Practice 1

> She **knows better than to trust a stranger with her password**.

她知道**不應該把密碼交給陌生人**。

Practice 2

> He should **know better than to drive so fast**.

他應該知道**不應該開車那麼快**。

MCQ-ready definition:

know better than to do X = 有足夠常識或經驗知道做 X 是錯誤或不明智的

23. **think better of something** — 改變主意，決定不做

Practice 1

> I was going to complain, but I **thought better of it**.

我本來打算投訴，但後來**想想還是算了**。

Practice 2

> He nearly sent the angry message but **thought better of it**.

他差點把那封憤怒的訊息傳出去，但後來**改變主意沒有傳**。

MCQ-ready definition:

****think better of something = 再想一想後認為原本的做法不明智，因此決定不做****

24. ****the better for something — 因某事而變得更好****

Practice 1

> The team is ****the better for**** having experienced that defeat.

經歷那次失敗後，球隊反而****變得更成熟 / 更好****。

Practice 2

> The story is ****better for**** being shorter.

這個故事因為較短，反而****效果更好****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****be the better for something = 因某件事而有所改善或變得更好****

25. ****all the better — 那就更好了****

Practice 1

> If you can finish today, ****all the better****.

如果你今天能完成，****那就更好了****。

Practice 2

> If Leo wants to help, ****all the better****.

如果 Leo 也想幫忙，****那就更加好了****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****all the better = 用來表示某個額外條件會令情況更加理想****

26. ****so much the better — 那就更好了；那更理想****

Slightly more formal than ****all the better****.

Practice 1

> If the problem can be solved today, **so much the better**.

如果今天就能解決問題，**那就更好了**。

Practice 2

> If we can save money as well, **so much the better**.

如果同時還可以省錢，**那就更加理想**。

MCQ-ready definition:

so much the better = 某個額外情況會令結果更加有利或理想

27. **better yourself** — 改善自己；提升自己

Here **better** is a verb.

Practice 1

> She took evening classes to **better herself**.

她修讀夜間課程來**提升自己**。

Practice 2

> He is always looking for ways to **better himself**.

他總是在尋找方法**改善自己、提升能力**。

MCQ-ready definition:

better yourself = 改善自己的能力、教育、生活條件或社會處境

28. **better a result / record** — 超過；改善紀錄

Verb use, somewhat formal.

Practice 1

> She **bettered** her previous record by two seconds.

她把自己之前的紀錄**提升了兩秒 / 打破了之前紀錄**。

Practice 2

> The company hopes to **better last year's sales figures**.

公司希望**超越去年的銷售數字**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****better something = 改善某項成績、數字或紀錄，使其比以前更好****

29. **no better than — 不比……好；和……一樣差**

Practice 1

> This version is **no better than** the old one.

這個版本**一點也不比舊版本好**。

Practice 2

> His second attempt was **no better than** the first.

他第二次嘗試**跟第一次一樣沒有改善**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****no better than X = 並不比 X 優勝，通常暗示兩者都不理想****

30. **better than nothing — 總比沒有好**

Practice 1

> The payment is small, but it's **better than nothing**.

報酬雖然少，但**總比沒有好**。

Practice 2

> Ten minutes of exercise is **better than nothing**.

做十分鐘運動也**總比完全不做來得好**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****better than nothing = 雖然不理想，但至少比完全沒有更好****

31. ****better late than never — 遲做總比不做好****

A very common proverb.

Practice 1

> You finally apologized—****better late than never****.

你終於道歉了——****遲做總比不做好****。

Practice 2

> He started exercising at sixty, but ****better late than never****.

他六十歲才開始運動，不過****有做總比不做好****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****better late than never = 某件好事即使遲了才做，也比完全不做好****

32. ****better luck next time — 下次好運；下次再努力****

Practice 1

> You didn't win this time—****better luck next time****.

你今次沒有贏——****下次好運 / 下次再努力****。

Practice 2

> “I failed the test.”

> “Never mind. ****Better luck next time.****”

「我考試不合格。」

「不要緊，****下次再努力吧。****」

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****better luck next time = 用來安慰失敗的人，希望他下一次結果更好****

Important distinction 1: **good** → better → best

This is irregular.

Not:

> ✗ **gooder**
> ✗ **goodest**

Correct:

* **good**
* **better**
* **best**

> This bridge is **good**.
> This bridge is **better**.
> This is the **best** bridge.

Important distinction 2: **well** → better → best

Better is also the comparative of **well**.

Adjective comparison

> This is a **better** design.

這是**更好的**設計。

Adverb comparison

> She sings **better** now.

她現在唱得**更好**。

So **better** can modify either:

* a **noun** → adjective
* a **verb** → adverb

Important distinction 3: **better** vs **best**

****better****

comparative: comparing two or relative improvement

> This one is ****better****.

這個比較好。

****best****

superlative: highest level among a group

> This one is the ****best****.

這個最好。

Your passage says:

> build a ****better**** one

because Leo means ****better than the broken one****, not necessarily ****the best bridge possible****.

Important distinction 4: ****better vs more good****

English does not normally say:

>  more good

Use:

>  ****better****

because ****good**** has an irregular comparative.

Important distinction 5: ****better vs improved****

****better****

means superior in quality/state.

> a ****better**** design

更好的設計

****improved****

means something has actually been changed so that it is better than before.

> an ****improved**** design

經過改良的設計

So:

****better**** describes comparison;

****improved**** highlights the process/result of improvement.

Important distinction 6: ****get better vs improve****

Very close.

****get better****

more conversational.

> My English is ****getting better****.

我的英語正在進步。

****improve****

more neutral/formal and can be transitive.

> My English is ****improving****.

我的英語正在進步。

> I want to ****improve my English****.

我想提升英語水平。

But:

>  better my English

is possible only in a more formal/less common verbal use and sounds much less natural than ****improve my English****.

Important distinction 7: ****better at vs better than****

****better at****

ability in an activity:

> She is ****better at drawing**** than I am.

她比我更擅長畫畫。

****better than****

direct comparison:

> Her drawing is ****better than mine****.

她的畫比我的好。

Important distinction 8: ****better for vs better at****

****better for****

more beneficial/suitable:

> Walking is ****better for your health****.

步行對健康更好。

****better at****

more skilled:

> He is ****better at running****.

他比較擅長跑步。

Important distinction 9: ****better off vs better****

better

general comparison:

> This plan is **better**.

這個計劃比較好。

better off

describes someone's **overall situation or outcome**:

> We'd be **better off waiting**.

我們等一等會比較有利。

You cannot freely replace one with the other.

Important distinction 10: **had better is not ordinary past tense**

This is very important.

> You **had better go** now.

does **not** mean:

> 你以前比較好地離開.....

It is a fixed modal-like construction meaning:

**你最好現在走。 **

Also:

> You'd better go.

Here **'d = had**, not **would**.

Important distinction 11: **had better vs should**

Both give advice, but:

should

general advice

> You **should rest**.

你應該休息。

had better

stronger; often implies consequences

> You'd **better rest**, or you'll make yourself worse.

你最好休息，否則情況會變差。

So **had better** often sounds more urgent or warning-like.

Important distinction 12: **better off doing vs had better do**

better off doing

focuses on which option produces a better result.

> You're **better off taking the train**.

乘火車對你比較有利。

had better do

is direct advice/warning.

> You'd **better take the train**.

你最好乘火車。

Similar practical outcome, different grammar and tone.

Important distinction 13: **know better vs know something better**

know better

fixed expression:

> You should **know better**.

你應該懂事 / 知道不該那樣做。

know something better

ordinary comparison of knowledge:

> I know this area **better** than he does.

我比他**更熟悉**這一區。

Completely different structures.

Important distinction 14: **better as adjective vs adverb**

Adjective

> a **better bridge**

一座**更好的橋**

Adverb

> He builds bridges **better** now.

他現在造橋造得**更好了**。

Same form, different grammatical function.

Important distinction 15: **better as adjective vs verb**

Adjective

> a **better result**

更好的結果

Verb

> She **bettered** her result**.**

她**改善 / 超越**了自己的**成績**。

The verb exists, but is much less common than adjective/adverb **better**.

Family-extension note

Better is a particularly useful learner item because it combines several grammatical functions under one form:

1. **comparative adjective of good**

- * a better bridge
- * a better idea

2. **comparative adverb of well**

- * work better
- * sing better

3. **improved state**

- * feel better
- * get better

4. **fixed comparative constructions**

- * better at
- * better for
- * better off

5. **modal-like expression**

- * had better

6. **noun-like comparative**

- * the better of the two
- * for the better

7. **verb**

- * better yourself
- * better a record

The key here is to separate **grammar functions** without pretending every construction is a wholly unrelated lexical meaning. The semantic core remains:

higher in quality, condition, effectiveness, suitability, or performance than another state or alternative

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
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better bridge	更好的橋	higher quality
better than X	比 X 更好	comparison
much better	好得多	strong improvement
slightly better	好一點	small improvement
get better	變好；康復	improve
feel better	感覺好多了	improved condition
look better	看起來更好	improved appearance
work better	運作得更好	adverbial performance
do better	表現更好	improved performance
better at X	更擅長 X	skill
better for X	對 X 更好	benefit/suitability
better suited to X	更適合 X	suitability
better option	較好的選擇	preferable choice
the better of two	兩者中較好的	comparative noun use
for the better	朝好的方向	positive change
better off	處境較好	advantageous situation
better off doing X	做 X 會比較好	advantageous choice
had better do X	最好做 X	strong advice
had better not X	最好不要 X	strong warning
know better	應該懂得不那樣做	good judgment
think better of it	改變主意不做	reconsider
all the better	那就更好了	added benefit
so much the better	那更加理想	stronger added benefit
better yourself	提升自己	improve oneself
better a record	改善 / 超越紀錄	surpass
no better than	不比.....好	no improvement
better than nothing	總比沒有好	imperfect but preferable
better late than never	遲做總比不做好	proverb
better luck next time	下次好運	consolation

For your original sentence

> “That's okay, we can build a **better** one.”

Here:

better = 更好的；比原本那一個更好的

The comparison is implicit:

> a **better one**

> = a bridge **better than the one that was broken**

So the full underlying meaning is:

> We can build another bridge, and **the new bridge can be even better than the first one**.

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 「沒關係，我們可以再造一座**更好的**。」

And this word matters nicely in the passage: Leo does not merely accept the accident—he immediately reframes it as an opportunity to **improve on what came before**.